Category Policy Addendum: Sports & Outdoors

KARTWAY INTERNAL OPERATIONS POLICY
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CATEGORY: Sports & Outdoors Addendum
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1.0 PURPOSE AND APPLICABILITY

1.1 This addendum defines category-specific exceptions, workflows, and compliance rules for the Sports & Outdoors department on the Kartway marketplace.

1.2 Where this document conflicts with the standard Kartway Customer Operations General Policy (KW-POL-GEN-001), the rules contained in this addendum shall take precedence for all transactions processed under the Sports & Outdoors category taxonomy.

2.0 RETURN WINDOW MODIFICATIONS

2.1 Notwithstanding the standard 30-day marketplace return window defined in KW-POL-GEN-001 section 4.2, all items classified under Sports & Outdoors are subject to a 45-day return window calculated from the confirmed delivery date.

2.2 Return initiation requests submitted on or between Day 46 and Day 60 post-delivery require manual override approval from a Tier 2 Support Lead and are exclusively eligible for Kartway site credit, never original form of payment refunds.

3.0 CATEGORY-SPECIFIC CONDITION REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Technical Footwear and Climbing Gear: Items in sub-categories such as mountaineering boots, harnesses, belay devices, and climbing ropes must show zero evidence of load-bearing stress, chalk residue, or tread wear. Footwear tried on for sizing must be tested exclusively on indoor carpeted surfaces.

3.2 Watercraft and Inflatables: Stand-up paddleboards (SUPs), kayaks, and inflatable rafts must be returned completely dry, free of marine debris, sand, or salt deposits. Items returned damp or dirty will incur a mandatory decontamination and drying processing fee as outlined in Section 5.0.

3.3 Bicycles and Frame Components: Bicycles must not show torque marks on seat posts, bottom brackets, or pedal threads exceeding 2 Newton-meters of assembly pressure. Derailleurs must be unbent.

4.0 ORIGINAL PACKAGING MANDATE

4.1 Original manufacturer packaging (including molded styrofoam inserts, cardboard cartons, and serialized hangtags) is mandatory for all electronic items within this category, including cycling computers, golf rangefinders, and handheld GPS units.

4.2 For non-electronic bulky goods (e.g., barbell sets, camping tents, heavy punching bags), original packaging is strongly encouraged but not strictly mandatory, provided the item is boxed securely in equivalent corrugated material to prevent transit damage.

5.0 RESTOCKING FEES AND DEDUCTIONS

5.1 A standard 12% restocking fee applies to all returned motorized recreation items, including electric bicycles, gas-powered augers, and trolling motors, regardless of condition, to cover safety diagnostic testing by certified technicians.

5.2 A 25% depreciation deduction applies to any seasonal team sports equipment (such as hockey gear, lacrosse sticks, and football pads) returned after the conclusion of the corresponding regional league season as defined by the Kartway Sports Calendar.

5.3 Items returned missing minor non-structural components (e.g., water bottle cage bolts, tent stakes, or valve caps) are subject to a flat $15 hardware replacement deduction per missing unit, up to a maximum cap of $45 per return.

6.0 HAZARDOUS, PRESSURIZED, AND PERISHABLE HANDLING

6.1 Pressurized Cylinders: Camp stove fuel canisters, CO2 cartridges for life vests, and paintball propellant tanks are strictly non-returnable once shipped, due to Department of Transportation hazardous materials regulations. Support agents must issue an immediate courtesy refund and instruct the customer to dispose of the item locally in accordance with municipal environmental ordinances. Return shipments containing pressurized containers will be refused at the Kartway fulfillment dock and destroyed without credit.

6.2 Nutritional Supplements and Hydration Mixes: Protein powders, electrolyte tablets, and energy gels carry a strict 14-day return window (which overrides the 45-day window in Section 2.1) and are only eligible for return if the safety foil seal is unbroken and tamper-evident bands remain intact. Opened nutritional goods must be marked as hazardous waste and disposed of immediately; agents must not authorize return transit for opened consumables.

7.0 WARRANTY PERIODS AND MANUFACTURER REDIRECTION

7.1 Kartway provides an extended 2-year limited functional warranty on all non-consumable Sports & Outdoors equipment sold directly by Kartway-verified merchants, covering manufacturing defects in materials and workmanship. This supersedes the standard 1-year general merchandise warranty.

7.2 For items manufactured by designated Tier-1 brands (specifically Trek, Garmin, Yeti, and Shimano), customer service agents must redirect the buyer directly to the manufacturer's authorized service center if the defect is reported after the initial 90-day merchant liability window. Kartway support agents are prohibited from issuing replacement units for these specific brands past the 90-day threshold without prior authorization from the Category Quality Assurance queue.

END OF ADDENDUM KW-POL-ADD-SPO-042